Ross Dahlke

Assistant Professor, School of Journalism and Mass Communication, University of Wisconsin–Madison

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Education

Stanford University *Palo Alto, CA*
PhD, Communication *2022–2024*

- Dissertation: *The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Politics, News, and Misinformation in Personal Messaging Applications*
- Committee: Jeffrey T. Hancock (Advisor, Communication), Jennifer Pan (Communication), Byron Reeves (Communication), Matthew Gentzkow (Economics), Michael Bernstein (Chair, Computer Science)
- Stanford Data Science Scholar *2023–2024*
- Knight-Hennessy Scholar *2022–2023*

Stanford University *Palo Alto, CA*
MA, Communication *2020–2022*

- Knight-Hennessy Scholar *2020–2022*

University of Wisconsin–Madison *Madison, WI*
JBA, Comprehensive Honors (Honors in the Liberal Arts and Honors in the Major), Journalism & Mass Communication and Political Science *2014–2018*

Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor *Madison, WI*
School of Journalism and Mass Communication · University of Wisconsin–Madison *2025–Present*

- Affiliate, Data Science Institute *2026–Present*
- Affiliate, Elections Research Center *2025–Present*
- Affiliate, RISE-AI (Wisconsin Research, Innovation and Scholarly Excellence–Artificial Intelligence) *2025–Present*

Honors & Awards

Top Paper Award, Information Systems Division *2026*
International Communication Association Conference

Best Paper Honorable Mention (top ∼5% of submissions) *2026*
ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division *2024*
International Communication Association Conference

Top Reviewer Award, 2023 *2024*
Social Science Computer Review

Theodore Herfurth Award *2018*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · top undergraduate male student in the university

College of Letters and Science Dean's Prize *2018*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · top three students in the college

James L. Baughman Senior Achievement Award *2018*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · top five students in the School of Journalism and Mass Communication

Research

Publications

Bold *= Dahlke · * equal or co-first authorship. Co-author status at time of submission: [#] graduate-student or postdoctoral · [‡] undergraduate · [^] untenured junior-faculty · [+] tenured-faculty. All listed articles are peer-reviewed.*

18. **Dahlke, R.**, Mine, N.[#], Zhao, H.[#], Huang, Y.[#], & Shah, D.[+] (2026). Electoral predictions on Polymarket: A quantitative description of trading, commenting, and reacting. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, 6. https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2026.011
    Coverage · The Washington Post

17. **Dahlke, R.**, Moore, R. C.[#], Adib-Azpeitia, D.[‡], Ugander, J.[^], & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2026). Multi-platform referrers of misinformation: A comparative analysis of misinformation visits referred by Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube, Snapchat, and TikTok. *Political Communication*. https://doi.org/10.1080/10584609.2026.2679492

16. **Dahlke, R.**, Yang, Y.[^], Lukito, J.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], Chen, B.[#], Brown, M. A.[#], & Lewis, R.[#] (2026). Style and substance on The Alex Jones Show predict InfoWars sales: A multi-modal analysis of a media empire. *Information, Communication & Society*, 29(4), 1386–1405. https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2026.2642851

15. **Dahlke*, R.**, Moore*, R. C.[#], Bengani, P., & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2026). The consumption of pink slime journalism: Who, what, when, where, and why? *Digital Journalism*, 1–23. https://doi.org/10.1080/21670811.2026.2669525
    Award · Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division of the International Communication Association 2024 Conference
    Coverage · Northwestern Local News Initiative, The Boston Globe

14. Kim, Y. M.[+], **Dahlke, R.**, Song, H.[^], & Heinrich, R. (2026). Targeted digital voter suppression efforts likely decrease voter turnout. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(5), e2519944123. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2519944123

13. Lee, A. Y.[#], Stevic, A.[#], Walker-Keleher, G.[‡], Chen, C.[‡], Charity, E.[‡], **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.[+] (2026). Going light: The effects of minimal mobile phone adoption on young adults' well-being depend on motivation. *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791723
    Award · Best Paper Honorable Mention (top ∼5% of submissions), ACM CHI 2026
    Coverage · The New York Times, CNBC

12. Lukito, J.[^], Zhang, Y.[^], Chen, B.[^], Prochaska, S.[#], Pruden, M. L.[^], Yang, Y.[^], Zhong, W.[^], Brown, M. A.[#], **Dahlke, R.**, Greenfield, J.[#], Suk, J.[^], & Borah, P.[+] (2026). Cross-platformization: How U.S. right-leaning media curate their posts on Twitter and Truth Social. *New Media & Society*. https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448261470889

11. Kwon, H.[#], Jiang, X.[#], & **Dahlke, R.** (2026). Do politicians' strategic facial displays drive resonant moments on social media? Computational analysis of the 2024 U.S. presidential debate using multimodal large language models. *International Journal of Communication*. Forthcoming.
    Award · Top Paper, Information Systems Division of the International Communication Association 2026 Conference

10. **Dahlke*, R.**, Tu*, F.[#], Wang*, Y.-C.[#], Lu, Y.[^], Engeda, B. W.[‡], & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2025). Contextualizing misinformation: A user-centric approach to linguistic and topical patterns in news consumption. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 9(CSCW1), 1–40. https://doi.org/10.1145/3757571
    Note · PACM HCI is a peer-reviewed journal (ACM CSCW track).

9. **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.[+] (2025). Untrustworthy website exposure and election beliefs: Selective exposure and ideological asymmetry. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(1). https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i1.250

8. **Dahlke, R.**, Kumar, D.[#], Durumeric, Z.[^], & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2025). Quantifying the systematic bias in the accessibility and inaccessibility of web scraping content from URL-logged web-browsing digital trace data. *Social Science Computer Review*, 43(5), 1071–1086. https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393231218214

7. Lukito, J.[^], Macdonald, M.[^], Chen, B.[#], Brown, M. A.[#], Prochaska, S.[#], Yang, Y.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], Suk, J.[^], Zhong, W.[#], **Dahlke, R.**, & Borah, P.[+] (2025). Candidates be posting: Multi-platform strategies and partisan preferences in the 2022 US midterm elections. *Social Media+ Society*, 11(2), 20563051251337541. https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251337541

6. **Dahlke, R.**, & Pan, J.[+] (2024). January 6 arrests and media coverage do not remobilize conservatives on social media. *Proceedings of the National Academies of Sciences*. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2401239121

5. Moore*, R. C.[#], **Dahlke*, R.**, Forberg, P. L.[#], & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2024). The private life of QAnon: A mixed methods investigation of Americans' exposure to QAnon content on the web. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 8(CSCW2), 1–34. https://doi.org/10.1145/3687057
    Note · PACM HCI is a peer-reviewed journal (ACM CSCW track).

4. **Dahlke, R.**, & Zhang, Y.[^] (2024). Surviving or thriving political defeat on social media: A temporal analysis of how electoral loss exacerbates the gender gap in political expression. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1), zmad051. https://doi.org/10.1093/jcmc/zmad051

3. Chen, B.[#], Borah, P.[+], **Dahlke, R.**, & Lukito, J.[^] (2024). Battle for inbox and bucks: Comparing email fundraising strategies of Donald Trump and Joe Biden in the 2020 U.S. presidential election. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*. https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2024.012

2. Lukito, J.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], Yang, Y.[^], **Dahlke, R.**, Brown, M. A.[#], Lewis, R.[#], & Chen, B.[#] (2024). Audio-as-data tools: Replicating computational data processing. *Media and Communication*, 12. https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.7851

1. Moore*, R. C.[#], **Dahlke*, R.**, & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2023). Exposure to untrustworthy websites in the 2020 US election. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1096–1105. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-023-01564-2
    Coverage · The New York Times, World Economic Forum, Minnesota Star Tribune, The Daily Beast

Research in Progress

Manuscripts Under Review

***Bold** = Dahlke · * equal or co-first authorship. Co-author status at time of submission: [#] graduate-student or postdoctoral · [‡] undergraduate · [^] untenured junior-faculty · [+] tenured-faculty.*

3. **Dahlke*, R.**, Moore*, R. C.[^], & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2026). Exposure to (AI-generated) untrustworthy websites in the 2024 US election. Revise & Resubmit at *Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg_v1

2. **Dahlke, R.**, Lee, A. Y.[#], Stevic, A.[#], Walker-Keleher, G.[‡], Chen, C. Q.-A.[‡], Charity, E.[‡], & Hancock, J. T.[+] (2026). Replacing smartphones with minimal mobile phones improves college students' trust in news but not news-finds-me perceptions. Under Review.

1. **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.[+] (2025). The public sphere in private spaces: Quantifying political computer-mediated communication in personal messaging. Under Review. https://osf.io/6cpv8/

Working Papers & Reports

2. Huang, Y.[#], & **Dahlke, R.** (2026). Who reports using Polymarket? A demographic, attitudinal, and political analysis. *CODE Lab, University of Wisconsin–Madison*. https://rossdahlke.com/codelab/polymarket-users-2026.pdf

1. Lukito, J.[^], Brown, M. A.[#], **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J.[^], Yang, Y.[^], Zhang, Y.[^], Chen, B.[#], Kim, S. J.[^], & Soorholtz, K. (2023). The state of digital media data research, 2023. *Social Science Research Council*. http://dx.doi.org/10.26153/tsw/46177

Research Funding & Fellowships

Collaborative Summer Research Initiative *2025*
University of Wisconsin–Madison Elections Research Center **$10,700**

Non-Western Countries Expanding Online Trust & Safety Research Grant *2024*
Stanford Cyber Policy Center **$15,000**

Graduate Student Researcher *2020–2024*
Office of Army Research & DoD Multidisciplinary University Research Initiative (MURI): Multi-Modal Network Information Dynamics Group

Data Science Scholar *2023*
Stanford University Data Science ∼**$93,000**

Stanford EST (Ethics, Society, and Technology) Research Grant *2023*
Stanford University **$5,000**

Stanford PACS (Philanthropy and Civil Society) Research Grant *2023*
Stanford University **$3,000**

Knight–Hennessy Scholarship *2020*
Stanford University ∼**$280,000**

Presentations

Invited Talks & Guest Lectures

The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Political Content and Sources in Personal Messaging *March 2026*
Communication and Media Colloquium · University of Iowa

Exploring Ethical Use of AI and Computational Methods in Organizational Research *October 2025*
Organizational Communication Mini Conference 2025 · University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

The Consumption of Pink Slime Journalism: Who, What, When, Where, and Why? *March 2025*
J395: Language, Media, and Politics · University of Texas at Austin (Virtual)

Understanding Election Manipulation with Data Science *November 2024*
Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election *November 2023*
Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology · Stanford University

Untrustworthy Website Exposure and Effects *November 2023*
Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University

Single Case Research Methodology and Visualization *September 2023*
University of Minnesota–Twin Cities

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election *April 2023*
Social Technologies Research Group · Cornell Tech

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election *May 2022*
Cyber Policy Center, Freeman Spogli Institute · Stanford University

Teaching

Courses

JOURN / LIS (Information Science) 677 – Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization *Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

JOURN 818 – Computational Approaches for Communication Research *Fall 2025*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

COMM 124/224 – Truth, Trust & Technology *Spring 2024*
Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

COMM 172/272 – Media Psychology *Winter 2023*
Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

INTER-LS 250 – Undergraduate Research Experience *Fall 2016, Spring 2017, Fall 2017, Spring 2018*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Teaching Fellow

Professional Development

Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence Fellow *August 2025–May 2026*
Center for Teaching, Learning, and Mentoring · University of Wisconsin–Madison

The Discussion Project *August 2025*
Wisconsin Center for Education Research · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Wisconsin Idea Seminar *May 2025*
Office of the Provost · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Advising

PhD Advising

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang
PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Co-Advisor (with Dhavan Shah)

Laila Abbas
PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Co-Advisor (with Dhavan Shah)

Haotian (Barry) Zhao
PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Advisor

Research MA Advising

Yingqi (Vicky) Huang
MA, Journalism and Mass Communication · Advisor

Directed Study

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang *Spring 2026*
Directed Study

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang *Fall 2025*
Directed Study

Service

Departmental & University Service

Graduate Committee, School of Journalism and Mass Communication *January 2025–Present*
Member

SJMC COWathon (COding and Writing-athon) *October 2025*
Organizer

Professional Service

International Journal of Press + Politics *January 2025–Present*
Data Editor

Media & Democracy Data Cooperative (MDDC) *September 2020–Present*
Research Chair, Executive Board Member · https://mddatacoop.org/

Computation + Journalism 2026 Symposium, Northwestern University *May 2026–October 2026*
Program Committee Member · https://www.cj2026.northwestern.edu/

International Communication Association Hackathon *June 2023–June 2024*
Co-Organizer · https://www.hackingcommsci.org/

Digital Data Conference (D2C) *December 2021–April 2022*
Co-Organizer · https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/

Peer Review

- AI and Ethics
- Communication Methods and Measures
- Computational Communication Research
- Digital Journalism
- HKS Misinformation Review
- Human Communication Research
- Information Processing and Management
- International Journal of Communication
- International Journal of Public Opinion Research
- Journal of Communication
- Journal of Health Politics, Policy and Law
- Journal of Online Trust and Safety
- Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
- Journal of Right-Wing Studies
- Mass Communication & Society
- New Media & Society
- Online Information Review
- PLOS ONE
- Political Communication
- Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)
- Science Advances
- Social Science Computer Review
- Virtual Reality

Professional Experience

Data Scientist *Minneapolis, MN*
Ovative Group *2018–2020*